

Rise of Nationalism in India

1858-1905

PHASES OF NATIONAL MOVEMENT

- 1. Early Phase-The Moderate Phase (1885-1905):** Led by the educated middle class, influenced by Western liberal ideas; a vague vision for reform.
- 2. Second Phase- The Extremist Phase (1905-1918):** Expanded to social, cultural, economic, and political upliftment, with aspirations for self-government (**Swaraj**). Revolutionary methods gained popularity.
- 3. Final Phase- The Gandhian Phase (1919-1947):** Focused on **Purna Swaraj** (complete independence), led by **Mahatma Gandhi** through non-violent non-cooperation.

Factors in the Growth of Modern Nationalism

- Press and Literature:** By 1877, 169 regional newspapers (e.g., **The Bengalee**, **Kesari**, **The Hindu**) circulated 100,000 copies, advocating self-governance. Writers

like **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** and **Bharatendu Harishchandra** spread nationalist ideas.

- Rediscovery of India's Past:** Scholars like **Max Mueller**, **Monier Williams**, and **Swami Vivekananda** debunked colonial myths, emphasising India's rich heritage.
- Reform Movements:** **Brahmo Samaj**, **Arya Samaj**, and **Ramakrishna Mission** promoted unity and nationalism.
- Reactionary Policies:** **Lord Lytton's I.C.S. age reduction (1876)**, **Delhi Durbar (1877)**, **Vernacular Press Act (1878)**, and **Arms Act (1878)** sparked opposition.
- Western Thought:** Influences from thinkers like **Milton**, **Shelley**, **J.S. Mill**, and **Rousseau** shaped Indian nationalism.
- Global Influence:** Indian leaders, like **Naoroji**, **Tilak**, drew inspiration from global movements (e.g., **Italian unification**, **Irish Home Rule**).

Political Associations Before the Indian National Congress

Name Founders	Important Contribution
1836: Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha, Calcutta Associates Raja Rammohan Roy (Prasanna Kumar Thakur, Kalinath Chowdhury, Dwarkanath Tagore, Gouri Sankar Bhattacharya, Durga Prasad Tarka Panchanan)	Advocated for administrative reforms, Indian participation in administration, and education.
1837: Zamindari Association (Landholders' Society), Calcutta Dwarkanath Tagore, Radhakant Deb, Prasanna Kumar Tagore, Rajkamal Sen, Bhabani Charan Mitra	Safeguarded landlord's interests and laid the foundation for constitutional agitation.
1843: Bengal British India Society, Calcutta George Thompson, Dwarkanath Tagore, Chandra Mohan Chatterjee, Parmananda Maitra	Collected information on British India's welfare and promoted good citizenship among Indians.
1851: British Indian Association, Calcutta President: Radhakant Deb; General Secretary: Debendranath Tagore [UPSC 2017]	Merged Landholders Society and Bengal British India Society. Advocated for legislative reforms like establishing a separate legislature, separation of executive and judicial functions, and tax reductions. The petition referred to: 1. Establishment of Universities in the three presidencies (Bengal, Madras, and Bombay), 2. Establishment of a separate legislature of a popular character, 3. Separation of executive from judicial functions, 4. Reduction in salaries of higher officers, 5. Abolition of salt duty, abkari (intoxicant tax), and stamp duties. [UPSC 2017]

1852: Bombay Association, Bombay Jagannath Shankarsheth	Focused on petitioning for legislative reforms, advocated for Indian participation in governance, and critiqued colonial policies. Revived by Naoroji and Dadabhai Naoroji in 1876 but faced challenges from newer associations like the Western Indian Association.
1852: Madras Native Association (MNA), Madras Gajula Lakshminarasu Chetty	The first political association in the Madras Presidency. Focused on grievances of the landed gentry and countering Christian missionary activities and Lex Loci laws.
1866: East India Association, London Dadabhai Naoroji	Promoted Indian welfare, influenced British public opinion, and established branches in India.
1867: Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Poona Mahadev Govind Ranade (Joined later in 1871), G.V. Joshi, S.H. Sathe, S.H. Chiplonkar	Worked as a medium for public opinion and interaction between the government and people, focusing on social reform and political participation.
1875: Indian League, Calcutta Sisir Kumar Ghosh	Promoted nationalism and political education, expanding representation beyond the middle class.
1876: Indian Association (Indian National Association), Calcutta Surendranath Banerjee, Ananda Mohan Bose [UPSC 2017]	Led campaigns for Indian Civil Service reforms, Indianisation of administrative posts, and protests against repressive laws. Sponsored the All-India Conference in 1883. Campaign against the Repressive Arms Act and the Vernacular Press Act. Published "Indian Association's Journal". [UPSC 2017]
1883: All-India Conference, Calcutta Indian Association of Calcutta	Laid the groundwork for the Indian National Congress (INC), merging with it in 1886.
1884: Madras Mahajan Sabha, Madras M. Veeraraghavachari, P. Ananda Charlu, G. Subramania Iyer	Played a key role in advocating for Indian representation in legislative councils and contributed to coordinating local political efforts. Led the movement for segregation of judicial and revenue functions.
1885: Bombay Presidency Association, Bombay Pherozshah Mehta, K.T. Telang, Badruddin Tyabji	Founded as a response to Lord Lytton's policies and the Ilbert Bill controversy. Focused on advocating for Indian rights in the Bombay Presidency. Maintained strong links with the Poona Sarvajanik Sabha.
1885: London Indian Society, London Dadabhai Naoroji	Served as a platform for Indian students to voice political grievances. It was taken over by the East India Association in 1866.

Pre-Congress Campaigns

- **Import duty on cotton** (1875).
- **Indianisation of government service** (1878-79).
- Opposed **Lytton's Afghan adventure, Arms Act, and Vernacular Press Act** (1878).
- Advocated for the right to **join volunteer corps** and opposed **plantation labour** and **Inland Emigration Act** (1881-82).
- Supported **Ilbert Bill** (1883) for Indian judges to try British criminals.
- Campaigned in **Britain** for pro-India parties.
- Led **Indian Civil Service Agitation** (1877-80) against age limit reduction for ICS exams.
- **Peasant Issues:** Supported **Indigo Riots** (Bengal), **Deccan Riots** (Poona), and **water tax protests** (Chenab

Canal Colony, Punjab). Social work by groups like **Poona Sarvajanik Sabha**, connecting peasants to nationalist movements.

INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS

Foundation and the Moderate Phase

- **A.O. Hume**, a retired British civil servant, played a key role in founding the INC, collaborating with leaders like **Dadabhai Naoroji, Dinshaw Wacha, and Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee**.
- **First Congress Session (December 1885):** Held at **Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay**, with 72 delegates, mostly lawyers. **Lord Dufferin** was the British Viceroy at the time. Focused on loyalty to the British Crown while advocating for Indian welfare and representation.
- **Annual Meetings:** Held in December each year across India.

Theories Behind its Formation

1. Safety Valve Theory

- **Origin:** Proposed by William Wedderburn in his 1913 biography of Hume.
- **Context:** In 1878, Hume discovered secret reports revealing significant discontent among the lower classes and plans to overthrow British rule. Concerned, he met with Lord Dufferin to create a platform for educated Indians.
- **Lala Lajpat Rai** and **R.P. Dutt** supported it, but modern historians reject the theory.

2. Lightning Conductor Theory

- **Insight by Gokhale:** Gopal Krishna Gokhale suggested that the British would not have tolerated a revolutionary movement initiated by Indians; hence, A.O. Hume's involvement was crucial.
- **Function:** While Hume viewed the INC as a means to manage political discourse, Indian leaders sought to use it as a 'lightning conductor' to channel nationalist sentiments.
- **Bipan Chandra's Perspective:** Chandra noted the dual vision—while the British hoped to control

dissent, Indian leaders aimed to leverage this platform for greater nationalistic awakening.

Evolution of the INC

- The formation of the INC was a culmination of political awakening dating back to the **1860s and 1870s**, gaining momentum by the **late 1870s and early 1880s**.
- The INC served as a platform for **national unity** and **political representation** against colonial rule and was driven by a desire for **political education** and **national engagement**, inspired by contemporary movements.
- **Shift in Objectives:** The INC transitioned from moderate petitions to assertive demands for self-rule.
- **Internal Dynamics within the INC:** In the early years, the INC was divided into two factions:
 - **Moderates:** Led by figures like Gopal Krishna Gokhale, they sought gradual reforms through petitions and collaboration with British officials.
 - **Extremists:** Led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak and others, they advocated for Swaraj and were willing to adopt more aggressive tactics, including boycotts and protests.

IMPORTANT CONGRESS SESSIONS

Year, Location, President	Key Resolutions/Events
1885, Bombay, W.C. Bannerjee, 1st Congress President.	First session of the Indian National Congress (INC), attended by 72 delegates.
1886, Calcutta, Dadabhai Naoroji	Merger of INC with the National Conference, strengthening the INC's foundation. Naoroji presided over the INC three times (1886, 1893, 1906).
1887, Madras, Badruddin Tyabji	First Muslim President of INC; Appeal to Muslims to join INC. [UPSC 2015]
1888, Allahabad, George Yule	First Englishman (non-Indian) to become INC President.
1896, Calcutta, Rahimatullah M. Sayani	Vande Mataram' sung for the first time by Rabindranath Tagore in a Congress session.
1905, Benaras, Gopal Krishna Gokhale	Formal proclamation of the Swadeshi Movement against the British; boycott of foreign goods, promotion of Swadeshi goods and Indian industries.
1906, Calcutta, Dadabhai Naoroji	Resolutions on Swaraj (Self-Government), Boycott Movement, Swadeshi, and National Education adopted.
1907, Surat, Rash Behari Ghosh	Split between Moderates and Extremists within INC; session adjourned.
1910, Allahabad, Sir William Wedderburn	M.A. Jinnah criticised the separate electorate system introduced by the Indian Councils Act, 1909.
1911, Calcutta, B.N. Dhar	Jana Gana Mana' sung for the first time in a Congress session, marking the beginnings of national unity.
1915, Bombay, Sir S.P. Sinha	Congress constitution altered to admit delegates from the extremist section, reflecting internal shifts within the INC.

1916, Lucknow, A.C. Majumdar	Unity between Moderates and Extremists in INC; Lucknow Pact signed with the Muslim League.
1917, Calcutta, Annie Besant	First female President of INC. [UPSC 2015, 2013]
1918, Bombay (Special session), Syed Hasan Imam	Special session to deliberate on the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms and INC's participation in British reforms.
1919, Amritsar, Motilal Nehru	Support for the Khilafat Movement; Condemnation of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
1920, Calcutta (Special session), Lala Lajpat Rai	Non-Cooperation Movement (NCM) resolution moved by Mahatma Gandhi, aiming at non-violent resistance against British rule.
1920, Nagpur, C. Vijayaraghavachariar	Reorganisation of Congress on linguistic grounds; M.A. Jinnah left the INC.
1922, Gaya, C.R. Das	Formation of the Swaraj Party after breaking away from INC, reflecting ideological differences.
1924, Belgaum, M.K. Gandhi	Only session presided over by Mahatma Gandhi, emphasising his leadership within INC.
1925, Kanpur, Sarojini Naidu	First Indian woman President of INC.
1927, Madras, Dr. M.A. Ansari	Resolution passed against using Indian troops overseas and boycott of the Simon Commission; Resolution on Purna Swaraj.
1928, Calcutta, Motilal Nehru	Formation of the All India Youth Congress to engage younger generations in the independence movement. Acceptance of Nehru Report recommending Dominion status.
1929, Lahore, Jawaharlal Nehru	Poorna Swaraj' resolution passed; decision to launch Civil Disobedience Movement; January 26, 1930 declared as Independence Day.
1931, Karachi, Vallabhbhai Patel	Endorsement of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact; Resolutions on Fundamental Rights and National Economic Programme.
1934, Bombay, Rajendra Prasad	Amendment in the Constitution of Congress, signalling the need for an updated organisational framework.
1936, Lucknow, Jawaharlal Nehru	Emphasis on socialist principles in Congress policies, marking a shift toward left-wing economic ideas.
1937, Faizpur, Jawaharlal Nehru	First Congress session held in a village, emphasising a connection to grassroots and rural India.
1938, Haripura, Subhas Chandra Bose	National Planning Committee established for India's economic development post-independence.
1939, Tripuri, Subhas Chandra Bose/ Rajendra Prasad	Subhas Chandra Bose re-elected but resigned after disputes; Rajendra Prasad took over; Formation of the Forward Bloc by Bose.
1940, Ramgarh, Abul Kalam Azad	Decision to leave the final call on launching the Civil Disobedience Movement to Mahatma Gandhi.
1946, Meerut, J.B. Kripalani	Last session before Indian independence; J.B. Kripalani was the INC president at the time of independence.

MODERATES (1885-1905) AND EXTREMIST PHASE (1905-1919)

Aspect	Moderates (1885-1905)	Extremists (1905-1919)
Social Base Ideological Inspiration	Wealthy landowners, upper-middle classes, educated professionals. Western liberal philosophy, parliamentary principles, belief in British justice, gradual reforms.	Educated middle and lower-middle classes, masses in rural areas. Inspired by Indian history, cultural heritage, self-rule (Swaraj), rejection of British rule.
Views on British Rule	Believed Britain had a divinely ordained mission to rule India, colonial rule beneficial in some ways.	Rejected British rule as exploitative, unjust, viewed British authority as illegitimate.
Involvement of Masses	Movement confined to educated middle class, felt masses were politically unaware.	Faith in the masses ability to engage in political activism, advocated for widespread participation.
Key Demands	Constitutional reforms increased Indian representation, promoted civil service Indianisation, introduced legislative elections, and Indian members to the Viceroy's Executive Council, ("No Taxation without Representation"). Administrative changes included raising the ICS exam age limit, conducting exams in India, reducing defence costs, and addressing bureaucratic oppression, Economic reforms.	Swaraj (Self-rule): Emphasised complete independence from British rule, empowering masses, expanding Congress's social base. Economic: Promoted self-reliance, indigenous industries, Swadeshi (self-power), national education.
Methods of Struggle	Petition, prayer, propaganda, constitutional agitation through petitions, resolutions, press, public meetings.	Boycotts, passive resistance, protests, militant agitation, direct confrontation with British, use of traditional festivals for political mobilisation, volunteer organisations (Samitis).
Nature of Patriotism	Patriotic, focused on reforming the colonial system, relied on British fairness and liberal ideals.	Passionate patriots, willing to endure sacrifices and confront British oppression for independence.
Economic Reforms	Critiqued colonial economic policies, advocated for industrial development, reduction in land taxes, fiscal policies benefiting Indians.	Advocated for self-reliance in economic matters, promotion of indigenous industries, banks, local businesses.
Educational Reforms	Focused on expanding modern education, raising political consciousness, emphasising English and Western-style education.	Supported national education promoting indigenous culture, languages, and values, establishing national institutions.
Cultural Impact	Less emphasis on cultural revival, focused more on political and administrative reform.	Strong emphasis on cultural revivalism, use of Hindu mythology, traditions, festivals for political mobilisation.
Relations with the Press	Used press for political discourse, raising public awareness, and criticising British policies.	Used press with a radical tone, promoting nationalism and resistance against colonial rule.
Role of Women and Other Groups	Limited involvement of women and marginalised groups, mostly educated elites.	Encouraged active participation of women, students, workers, and expanded activism to a wider base.
Leaders	Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Pherozeshah Mehta, R.C. Dutt, Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee Mahadev Govind Ranade, Surendranath Banerjee, Badruddin Tyabji, Rash Behari Ghosh.	Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Lala Lajpat Rai, Aurobindo Ghosh, Subramania Bharati, Veer Savarkar, Chidambaram Pillai, Rash Behari Bose, C.R. Das

Evaluation of the Moderate Phase (1885-1905)

The **Moderate Phase** laid the foundation for India's independence movement, advocating reforms within British rule. Key achievements:

- **Public Service Commission (1886):** Enabled Indian civil service participation.
- **Indian Councils Act (1892):** Expanded councils and introduced indirect elections but offered limited power.
- **House of Commons Resolution (1893):** Recognized Indian participation in administration.
- **Welby Commission (1895):** Supported critiques of British economic policies, acknowledging India's economic burdens.

Others

Economic Critiques: Dadabhai Naoroji's Drain of Wealth Theory argued British policies depleted India's wealth. British imports led to deindustrialization, harming local industries and increasing poverty. The Zamindari system exploited peasants with high rents, causing agrarian distress, while infrastructure mainly served British interests, neglecting Indian welfare.

- **Reform Goals:** Aimed at Indianizing civil services, establishing judicial independence, decentralising finances, and improving education.

Causes for the Rise of Extremism (1905)

- **Colonial Exploitation: Drain Theory** exposed British exploitation. Key works: Naoroji's *Poverty and Un-British Rule*, Ranade's *Essays on Indian Economics*, Dutt's *Economic History of India*.
- **Crisis (1896-1900):** Famines, plagues, unrest highlighted British failures.
- **Nationalist Dissatisfaction: Indian Councils Act (1892)** failed; deportations of leaders like Natu brothers.

- **Bengal Partition (1905):** Symbolised **divide and rule**, spurring protests.
- **Global Anti-Imperialist Influence: Japan's victory (1905)** over Russia, **Boer War defeats (1899-1902)** inspired militancy.
- **Militant Leaders: Tilak, Lajpat Rai, Aurobindo Ghosh, Bipin Chandra Pal** advocated **Swaraj** and direct action.
- **Curzon's Policies: Calcutta Corporation Act (1899), Delhi Durbar (1902), Indian Universities Commission (1902), Indian Official Secret Act (1904)** fueled discontent.

Evaluation of the Extremist Phase

- **National Awakening:** Ignited a strong sense of nationalism, shifting the Indian freedom struggle from elite petitions to mass demands for Swaraj (self-rule).
- **Swadeshi and Boycott Movements:** Launched the Swadeshi Movement and encouraged the boycott of British goods, promoting economic self-reliance.
- **Cultural Revival:** Fostered pride in India's heritage, countering British claims of cultural superiority.
- **Youth Mobilisation:** Successfully inspired the youth to engage in the struggle, adding a dynamic element to the movement.
- **Revolutionary Ideas:** Introduced concepts of armed resistance, fostering a spirit of defiance against colonial rule.

Legacy

- This phase laid the groundwork for future strategies, especially under Gandhi, and emphasised the importance of inclusive political engagement that addressed social, economic, and cultural dimensions of the movement.

